

7. Expressing Similarities and Differences

Definition:

Expressing similarities and differences is the process of comparing and contrasting two people or things.

When we compare, we look for similarities (common points).

When we contrast, we look for differences.

How can we express similarities and differences?

7. One of the easiest ways is making a table with two categories: We can use coordinating and subordinating conjunctions such as: and, but, both, while, whereas, nor, also

2. Another way is writing a paragraph using expressions for similarities and differences.

Expressions of Similarities: the same, alike, similar, similarly, like, look like, both, also, as...as

Expressions of Differences:

different, not alike, dissimilar, differently, unlike, in contrast, but, while as different as

Example 7: Comparing Ahmed to his twin brother
Ahmed and his twin are alike.

They both have the same car.

Ahmed and his twin read similarly.

Ahmed is tall like his twin.

Ahmed and his twin have similar houses. Finally, they both look like their mother.

Example 2: Contrasting an apple and an orange

The apple and the orange are not alike.

They have different colors.

The apple is sweet, unlike the orange.

They grow differently.

The orange is sour in contrast to the apple.

Homework:

7. Write a paragraph comparing Leila to her sister.

2. Write another paragraph contrasting a cat and a tiger using expressions like: different, unlike, differently, dissimilar, but.

2. Talking about Ability

Why do we use modal auxiliaries like: can, to be able to, will be able to?

These expressions are used to talk about:

Ability

Lack of ability

Examples:

Ability:

I can drive a car.

They will be able to swim.

I was able to clean my room.

Lack of Ability:

I can't drive a car.

They won't be able to swim.

I wasn't able to clean my room.

Note:

Modal auxiliaries never take an -s or any other endings.

We say:

I can cook

He can cook

(not he cans cook)

Questions using modal verbs:

Were they able to visit Paris?
Will you be able to learn English?
Could you help us?
Are they able to organize their
work? Is he able to drink coffee?
Can Fati attend classes today?

3. Talking about Illness

How to talk about your health situation:

Use expressions like:

I have a pain in my side/hand.

I have an ache in my stomach.

I have a headache /stomachache / backache.

I have a fever.

How to ask about illness:

May I help you?

What are you suffering from?

What is your health problem?

How do you feel now?

How to ask for medicine:

Please give me a pill.

I need a painkiller.

Give me a pomade.

How to give medicine:

Take one pill three times a day (morning, afternoon, evening).

Use this pomade twice a day.

Take this medicine once a day.

Example conversation:

Customer: May I help you?

Clerk: Yes, please. I have pain in my side, an ache in my stomach, and a headache. I need a pill, an aspirin, a painkiller—something fast!

Clerk: Sorry, that's not my job. That's Mr. Brown's job.

Customer: May I see Mr. Brown, please?

Clerk: Mr. Brown is on the phone.

Customer: Can I see his helper?

Clerk: She's busy too. Please wait.

Customer: Oh no!

(Later)

Mr. Brown: May I help you?

Customer: Yes. I have pain in my side, an ache in my stomach, and a headache. Please give me a pill.

Mr. Brown: I'm not a doctor, I'm a pharmacist. You need a prescription.

4. Spelling Noun Plurals

Rules for plural nouns:

7. Add -s for most

nouns: writer writers

actor actors chair chairs

2. Add -es if the noun ends in: -ss, -ch, -sh, -x, -z boss bosses branch branches box boxes quiz quizzes

3. If a noun ends in a consonant +y, change y to i and add -es: city cities lady ladies university universities

4. If a noun ends in a vowel + y, just add -s: boy boys play plays

5. Irregular plurals: man men woman
women child children foot feet tooth teeth
mouse mice

